



Nutrition

Overview

Impact

WHO response

Nutrition is a critical part of health and development. Better nutrition is related to improved infant, child and maternal health, stronger immune systems, safer pregnancy and childbirth, lower risk of non-communicable diseases (such as diabetes and cardiovascular disease), and longevity.

Healthy children learn better. People with adequate nutrition are more productive and can create opportunities to gradually break the cycles of poverty and hunger.

Malnutrition, in every form, presents significant threats to human health. Today the world faces a double burden of malnutrition that includes both undernutrition and overweight, especially in low- and middle-income countries. There are multiple forms of malnutrition, including undernutrition (wasting or stunting), inadequate vitamins or minerals, overweight, obesity, and resulting diet-related noncommunicable diseases.

The developmental, economic, social, and medical impacts of the global burden of malnutrition are serious and lasting for individuals and their families, for communities and for countries.

[Learn about Nutrition and Food Safety and COVID-19](#)

Fact sheets



Questions and answers



Databases and tools



Initiatives and groups



Resolutions and decisions



Technical work



News

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29 June 2026_ | Note for Media

Forty-ninth session of the FAO/WHO Codex Alimentarius Commission adopts new standards

12 May 2026_ | Departmental update

WHO launches revamped SHAKE package to help reduce salt intake

28 January 2026_ | Departmental update

New WHO Collaborating Centre established to support work on food safety and healthy diet

27 January 2026_ | News release

WHO urges schools worldwide to promote healthy eating for children

Publications

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1 July 2026



Supporting healthy diets and safe foods in urban food environments

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23 June 2026



Ensuring competency for providers of breastfeeding support and care

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29 May 2026



Pesticide residues in food: report 2025: Joint FAO/WHO Meeting on Pesticide Residues

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14 May 2026



Marketing of breast-milk substitutes: national implementation of the International Code,...

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Our work

Addressing nutrition in emergencies

Measuring child growth through data

Reducing population sodium/salt intake

Establishing global nutrient requirements

Promoting safe food handling

Strengthening nutrition surveillance

Events

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Forty-ninth session of the FAO/WHO Codex Alimentarius Commission adopts new standards

 6 – 10 July 2026

WHO estimates of the global burden of foodborne diseases 2000–2021: Key findings from the 2026 edition

 4 June 2026 11:30 – 12:30 CET

Launch of the WHO guideline on policies and interventions to create healthy school food environments

📅 27 January 2026 13:00 – 14:00 CET

Documents

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7 July 2026

One-hundred-and-second meeting - Joint FAO/WHO Expert Committee on Food... Additives (JECFA)

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12 May 2026

FAO/WHO workshop on risk assessment of food allergens

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Feature stories

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10 April 2025

Donors making a difference in support of WHO's global work for better nutrition for all

Facts in pictures

22 February 2018

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WHO SIDS Summit for Health

Infographic

WHO Supports Small Island Developing States

Infographic

Food Security is a Challenge in Small Island Developing States

Infographic

Nutrition ferritin - iron from your food

Videos

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12 August 2025

**Food safety: turning information into action -
Webinar by the WHO - 3 June 25**

6 May 2024

**Global sodium benchmarks for reducing sodium
content in food products - WHO Webinar**

4 March 2024

WHO's department of nutrition and food safety: key achievements 2023

20 February 2024

Trans fat elimination validation award ceremony - 29 January 2024

Podcasts

Episode #101 - Do sweeteners help with weight loss?

Do non-sugar sweeteners help with weight loss? Do they pose a risk to your health? What about so called “natural” sweetness like Stevia? Jason Montez explains the findings from the new WHO report in Science in 5.

Episode #91 - Everything you need to know about trans fat

WHO is urging action by Governments and the food industry to remove industrial trans fat from our food chain. Which foods contain trans fat? How do they harm us? WHO's Dr Francesco Branca explains in Science in 5.

Related health topics

Conditions

Anaemia

Health interventions

Infant nutrition

Other

Food fortification

Diseases and conditions

Malnutrition

Physical environment

Food safety

Substances

Micronutrients

Human behaviour

Healthy diet

Conditions

Obesity